



Transcend JetFlash 150 1 GB
Fast and fully-loaded

Features

The Corsair Readout 1 GB has an external display that shows you the drive label and the free space available—no more plugging it in to check! The display does not require any external power, and stays on for a good one year.

The PQI CoolDrive U339S, SanDisk Cruzer Micro and Cruzer Titanium are U3 drives (see box U3). While all of them have PC synchronisation features, PQI's software lets you select the sync direction—from PC to drive or from drive to PC. The Lexar JumpDrive FireFly comes loaded with Google software for Windows—including Google Toolbar for Internet Explorer, Google Desktop, and Picasa.

Build Quality And Bundle

The Corsair Flash Voyager, with its rubber and water-resistant exterior, was the toughest of



Corsair Flash Voyager 1 GB
Built like a mini-truck!

U3

U3 is a new standard formed by leading Flash drive manufacturers to provide customers with the ability to carry their favourite software and applications along on their drives. If you need to use a particular software on a PC where you don't have Administrator rights, this feature can come in quite handy. The U3 interface lets you manage your data, install and uninstall software, and search for new U3 software over the internet.

Though U3 has its uses, it can be irritating for some: the U3 menu pops up every time you plug in the drive. As of now, the feature only works with Windows XP, so people using other operating systems won't be able to take advantage of it.

the lot—it bounced back safely every time we tossed it around. The PQI CoolDrives—true to their names—look cool and have decent build quality. The SanDisk Cruzer Titanium has very good build quality, and retains the retracting USB connector found on the SanDisk Cruzer Mini. Most drives came with a lanyard cord and some with a USB extension cable—real handy when your PC is placed under the table—but the Transcend JetFlash 130 was different, with two different coloured caps.

Performance

Since these drives have larger capacities, they can easily accommodate a single DivX movie (roughly 700 MB). The Transcend JetFlash 150 took just a minute to transfer a 700 MB video file. The Zion was at its heels, and took 64.8 seconds for the same task. These drives took less than a third of the category average of 192 seconds. The full-capacity assorted file test took 82.9 seconds to complete on the Transcend JetFlash 150m and a close 91.7 on the Zion. The Corsair Flash Voyager took a little more than two minutes to complete the task. Considering the average time of 274 seconds, these scores are really impressive. If you are looking for sheer performance, the Transcend JetFlash 150 and the Zion are the drives for you.

In Sum

The Transcend JetFlash 150 gets Gold for its blazing speed and feature-rich bundle. The Corsair Flash Voyager claims the Silver for decent performance, rugged build quality, and a good software bundle. Once again, Zion just misses the Silver for lack of accessories and software.

2 GB DRIVES

Nine drives turned up in this category: SanDisk sent in three, and Corsair, iball, Lexar, TECH-COM, Transcend, and Zion sent in one each. This category is for those who use pen drives to transfer large amounts of data such as MP3s, movie clips, and games. Speeds fall again because of increased storage space.

Features

There's nothing different about the drives' bundled software—it was similar to what came with the 1 GB drives. Since these drives are a bit expensive, some more value-added software wouldn't have disappointed.

Build Quality And Bundle

The Corsair Flash Voyager comes up tops again with its superior build quality. The SanDisk Cruzer Titan is built well, is quite sturdy, but its metallic lustre may fall prey to dust and rough use. Its retracting USB connector can act as a dust trap in dusty environments.

Performance

The Zion led the way, taking 89.7 seconds to transfer a 700 MB video file. This is a little more than the fastest 1 GB drive. The SanDisk Cruzer